

# Yining Nie [jɪˈnɪŋ ˈni:]

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CV updated: March 2023

## Research Interests

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Comparative syntax and morphology, argument structure, language development, morphology-phonology interface, Tagalog and Austronesian languages

## Academic Appointments

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- 2022– **Assistant Professor**  
Department of Linguistics and Language Development, San José State University
- 2021–2022 **Postdoctoral Researcher**  
Department of English and American Studies, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin  
ERC project *Realizing Leibniz's Dream: Child Languages as a Mirror of the Mind*  
Compressor Group, PIs: Artemis Alexiadou, Maria Teresa Guasti, Uli Sauerland

## Education

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- 2020 **Ph.D. in Linguistics**, Department of Linguistics, New York University  
Dissertation: *Licensing arguments*  
Committee: Alec Marantz (chair), Stephanie Harves, Richard Kayne, Gary Thoms, Laura Kalin (Princeton University)
- 2019 **M.Phil. in Linguistics**, Department of Linguistics, New York University
- 2015 **M.A. in Linguistics**, Department of Linguistics, University of Toronto  
Thesis: *French morphology and the pieces of verbal inflection*  
Advisor: Elizabeth Cowper
- 2014 **B.A. (Hons.) in Linguistics**, Trinity College, University of Cambridge

## Grants and Fellowships

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- 2023–2025 RSCA Seed Grant, Office of Research, San José State University
- 2017–2019 Bernard and Julia Bloch Memorial Fellowship, Linguistic Society of America
- 2016–2020 SSHRC Doctoral Fellowship, Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada
- 2016–2019 Joseph-Armand Bombardier Canada Graduate Scholarships Doctoral Fellowship, Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada (declined)
- 2015 B. Elan Dresher Phonology Prize, Department of Linguistics, University of Toronto
- 2011–2014 Blyth Cambridge Commonwealth Trust Scholarship, Blyth Education & Cambridge Commonwealth Trust

## Publications

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\* = lead author

### Peer-reviewed Journal Articles

- Accepted **Nie, Yining**. Applicative recursion and nominal licensing. *Linguistic Inquiry* (pending final revisions).
- To appear **Nie, Yining**. Turkish causatives are recursive: A response to Key 2013. *Linguistic Inquiry*. DOI: 10.1162/ling\_a\_00472
- 2021 Kouneli, Maria\* and **Yining Nie\***. Across-the-board tonal polarity in Kipsigis: Implications for the morphology-phonology interface. *Language* 92(2): e111–e138. DOI: 10.1353/lan.2021.0030
- 2020 **Nie, Yining**. Morphological causatives are Voice over Voice. *Word Structure* 13(1): 102–126. DOI: 10.3366/word.2020.0161
- 2019 **Nie, Yining**. Raising applicatives and possessors in Tagalog. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 14(1), 139: 1–30. DOI: 10.5334/gjgl.941
- 2019 Warstadt, Alex,\* Yu Cao,\* Ioana Grosu,\* Wei Peng,\* Hagen Blix,\* **Yining Nie,\*** Anna Alsop,\* Shikha Bordia,\* Haokun Liu,\* Alicia Parrish,\* Sheng-Fu Wang,\* Jason Phang,\* Anhad Mohananey,\* Phu Mon Htut,\* Paloma Jeretič,\* and Samuel R. Bowman. Investigating BERT’s Knowledge of Language: Five Analysis Methods with NPIs. *Proceedings of the 2019 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*. DOI: 10.18653/v1/D19-1286

### Edited Volume

- 2020 Manova, Stela, Harald Hammarström, Itamar Kastner and **Yining Nie**. *What is in a morpheme?* *Word Structure* 13(1). Edinburgh University Press. ISSN: 1750-1245.

### Conference Proceedings and Invited Contributions

- To appear Hein, Johannes,\* Imke Driemel,\* Fabienne Martin,\* **Yining Nie\*** and Artemis Alexiadou. Errors of multiple exponence in child language. *Proceedings of the 40th West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics*.
- 2022 Lee, Soo-Hwan\* and **Yining Nie\***. Korean case stacking and the nominal template. In Johanna Benz and Yiran Chen (eds.), *University of Pennsylvania Working Papers in Linguistics* 28: *Proceedings of 45th Annual Penn Linguistics Conference*, Article 11.
- 2022 Martin, Fabienne,\* **Yining Nie,\*** Artemis Alexiadou, and Maria Teresa Guasti. Wearing causation on its sleeve: Overt *cause* in child French causatives. In Ying Gong and Felix Kpogo (eds), *Proceedings of 46th annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*, 497–510. Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Press.
- 2020 Manova, Stela, Harald Hammarström, Itamar Kastner, and **Yining Nie**. What is in a morpheme? Theoretical, experimental and computational approaches to the relation of meaning and form in morphology. *Word Structure* 13(1). 1–21. DOI: 10.3366/word.2020.0157

- 2018 Hsieh, Henrison\* and **Yining Nie\***. Where (and what) the Tagalog *kung*-CPs are. In Laura Kalin, Ileana Paul and Jozina Vander Klok (eds.), *Heading in the right direction: Linguistic Treats for Lisa Travis. McGill Working Papers in Linguistics* 25.
- 2018 **Nie, Yining**. Contrast and prosody in derived environment effects. *Toronto Working Papers in Linguistics* 40: *Special issue from the Canada Research Chair-sponsored Phonology/Phonetics Workshops*.
- 2017 **Nie, Yining**. Why is there NOM-NOM and ACC-ACC but no ERG-ERG? In Andrew Lamont & Katerina Tetzloff (eds.), *Proceedings of 47th Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society, Volume 2*, 315–328.
- 2017 **Nie, Yining**. Phonetic enhancement and three patterns of English a-tensing. In Kajsa Djärv & Amy Goodwin Davies (eds.), *University of Pennsylvania Working Papers in Linguistics* 23: *Proceedings of 40th Annual Penn Linguistics Colloquium*, Article 21.
- 2016 **Nie, Yining**. Why is there NOM-NOM but no ERG-ERG? *Toronto Working Papers in Linguistics* 36: *Proceedings of the Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton 2016 Syntax Workshop*.
- 2015 **Nie, Yining**. Tense and modality in French verbal morphology. In Santa Vīnerte (ed.), *Proceedings of the 2015 Annual Conference of the Canadian Linguistics Association*.

### Unpublished Manuscripts

- 2017 Nie, Yining. Voice morphology and the features of vP. New York University: ms.  
<http://ling.auf.net/lingbuzz/003750>

### Other Resources

LITMUS Quasi-universal Nonword Repetition Tests (<http://www.bi-sli.org/qu-nonword-repetition>):

1. Italian, with Silvia Silleresi and Maria Teresa Guasti
2. Hungarian, with Lilla Pintér

### Presentations

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#### Invited Talks

- 2022 Recursion and thematic relations in causatives. Keynote, *15th Brussels Conference in Generative Linguistics*, Center for Research in Syntax, Semantics, and Phonology (CRISSP), KU Leuven, Belgium, October 6–7.
- 2022 with Johannes Hein, Imke Driemel, Fabienne Martin and Artemis Alexiadou. Redundant errors in child language. Colloquium, University of Leipzig, Germany, July 13.
- 2022 Two ways of forming causatives and their implications for recursion. Colloquium, San José State University, March 2 (virtual).
- 2022 Two ways of forming causatives and their implications for recursion. Colloquium, University of California Santa Cruz, February 23.
- 2021 Event distinctness and the cross-linguistic expression of causation. Colloquium, McMaster University, Canada, March 16 (virtual).

- 2021 The syntax of double object constructions: Evidence from recursion and symmetry. Colloquium, University of Konstanz, Germany, January 11 (virtual).
- 2020 Two ways of forming causatives and their implications for recursion. Comparative Syntax (ComSyn) group, Leiden University, Netherlands, October 29 (virtual).
- 2019 The limits of applicative recursion. Syntactic Theory @ Rutgers, Rutgers University, New Jersey, November 20.
- 2015 Contrast and prosodic preservation in derived environment effects. Keynote, *2015 Canada Research Chair-sponsored Summer Phonetics/Phonology Workshop*, University of Toronto, June 8.
- 2013 with Bert Vaux. Learning theory and language change: The evolution of phonological scope. Colloquium, University of Cambridge, October 24.

### Conference Talks

- 2023 with Fabienne Martin, Chiara Dal Farra, Silvia Silleresi, Artemis Alexiadou and Maria Teresa Guasti. Agent bias in child Italian event descriptions. *Linguistic Society of America 2023 Annual Meeting*, Denver, Colorado, January 5–8.
- 2022 with Fabienne Martin, Chiara Dal Farra, Silvia Silleresi, Artemis Alexiadou and Maria Teresa Guasti. Agentivity in child and adult Italian event descriptions. *Going Romance 2022*, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, November 30–December 2.
- 2022 with Silvia Silleresi, Chiara Dal Farra, Fabienne Martin, Artemis Alexiadou, and Maria Teresa Guasti. The agent bias holds in production too: Event descriptions in child Italian. *47th Boston University Conference on Language Development*, Boston University, November 3–6.
- 2022 with Chiara Dal Farra, Fabienne Martin, Maria Teresa Guasti and Artemis Alexiadou. Bigger is better! Older Italian children prefer heavy locative prepositions. *15th Generative Approaches to Language Acquisition Conference*. Goethe-Universität Frankfurt, Germany, September 22–24.
- 2022 with Fabienne Martin, Chiara Dal Farra and Silvia Silleresi. Who did it? How alternating verbs are interpreted under *faire*. *Syntactic Conferences at the University of Palermo 2022: The syntax of causative, perception and restructuring verbs in Romance and Latin*. University of Palermo, Italy, May 26–27.
- 2022 with Johannes Hein, Fabienne Martin and Artemis Alexiadou. Minimizing and maximizing exponence in child language. *40th West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics*, Stanford University, May 13–15 (virtual).
- 2021 with Johannes Hein, Fabienne Martin, Artemis Alexiadou and Imke Driemel. Multiple exponence in child language. *Multiple Exponence @ ZAS*, Leibniz-ZAS Berlin, December 1–3 (virtual).
- 2021 with Fabienne Martin, Elisabeth Backes and Daniil Bondarenko. Variation in the actuality inference of circumstantial modals. *Going Romance 2021*, Amsterdam, December 1–3 (virtual).

- 2021 with Fabienne Martin, Artemis Alexiadou and Maria Teresa Guasti. Wearing causation on its sleeve: Overt CAUSE in child French causatives. *46th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*, Boston University, November 4–7 (virtual).
- 2021 with Fabienne Martin, Elisabeth Backes and Daniil Bondarenko. Variation in the actuality inference of circumstantial modals. *Sensus 2021*, University of Massachusetts Amherst, October 1–2 (virtual).
- 2021 with Soo-Hwan Lee. Korean case stacking and the nominal template. *45th Annual Penn Linguistics Conference*, University of Pennsylvania, March 19–21 (virtual).
- 2020 Double causatives are real. *51st Meeting of the North East Linguistics Society*, Université du Québec à Montréal, November 6–8 (virtual).
- 2020 with Henrison Hsieh. Tagalog gerunds are antipassive. “Remarks: the Legacy” Workshop, *43rd Generative Linguistics in the Old World*, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, April 8–20 (virtual).
- 2019 with Alex Warstadt, Yu Cao, Ioana Grosu, Wei Peng, Hagen Blix, Anna Alsop, Shikha Bordia, Haokun Liu, Alicia Parrish, Sheng-Fu Wang, Jason Phang, Anhad Mohananey, Phu Mon Htut, Paloma Jeretič, and Samuel R. Bowman. Investigating BERT’s Knowledge of Language: Five Analysis Methods with NPIs. *2019 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, Hong Kong, November 3–7.
- 2019 with Ollie Sayeed and Bert Vaux. Scope expansion: an asymmetry in phonological change. *24th International Conference of Historical Linguistics*, Australian National University, July 1–5.
- 2019 Raising applicatives in Tagalog. *26th Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association*, Western University (University of Western Ontario), May 24–26.
- 2018 with Maria Kouneli. Paradigmatic tonal polarity in Kipsigis nominal modifiers. *49th Meeting of the North East Linguistics Society*, Cornell University, October 5–7.
- 2018 Voice and Austronesian-type voice morphology. *Linguistic Society of America 2018 Annual Meeting*, Salt Lake City, Utah, January 4–7.
- 2018 with Henrison Hsieh. Clausal arguments in Tagalog. Symposium on The Syntax of Clausal Arguments, *Linguistic Society of America 2018 Annual Meeting*, Salt Lake City, Utah, January 4–7.
- 2017 Austronesian voice morphology and the structure of causatives. *11th Arizona Linguistics Circle*, University of Arizona, October 20–22.
- 2017 Ergative Voice and the features of transitivity. *vP workshop*, University of Cambridge, June 17.
- 2016 Why is there NOM-NOM but no ERG-ERG? *47th Meeting of the North East Linguistics Society*, University of Massachusetts Amherst, October 14–16.
- 2016 Why is there NOM-NOM but no ERG-ERG? *Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton 2016 Syntax Workshop*, University of Toronto Mississauga, April 15–16.
- 2016 Phonetic enhancement and three patterns of English a-tensing. *40th Annual Penn Linguistics Conference*, University of Pennsylvania, March 18–20.

- 2016 Derived environment effects are prosodic, not morphological. *24th Conference of the Student Organisation of Linguistics in Europe*, York, UK, January 6–8.
- 2015 Go-support in the Québec French futures. *2015 Stony Brook-Yale-NYU-CUNY Graduate Linguistics Conference*, New York University, December 3.
- 2015 Tense and modality in French verbal morphology. *2015 Annual Conference of the Canadian Linguistics Association*, University of Ottawa, May 30–June 1.
- 2015 Morphological truncation in Harmonic Serialism. *Montréal-Ottawa-Laval-Toronto 2015 Phonology Workshop*, University of Toronto, March 13–15.

### Conference Posters

- (2023) with Johannes Hein, Imke Driemel, Fabienne Martin and Artemis Alexiadou. Errors of redundancy in child English and beyond. *46th Generative Linguistics in the Old World*, University of Vienna and University of Graz, Austria, April 11–15.
- 2021 with Fabienne Martin, Artemis Alexiadou and Maria Teresa Guasti. Two causatives for the price of one in child French. *Sensus 2021*, University of Massachusetts Amherst, October 1–2 (virtual).
- 2021 with Soo-Hwan Lee. Korean case stacking and triple nominatives. *Linguistic Society of America 2021 Annual Meeting*, January 7–10 (virtual).
- 2019 with Ollie Sayeed and Bert Vaux. Scope expansion: an asymmetry in phonological change. *5th Workshop on Sound Change*, University of California, Davis, June 21–23.
- 2019 Applicatives and the parameters of promotion. *Parameters Workshop in honour of Lisa Travis*, McGill University, May 17–18.
- 2019 Re- frozen scope in *spray-load* constructions. *Linguistic Society of America 2019 Annual Meeting*, New York City, January 3–6.
- 2018 Possessor raising and adversity in Tagalog. *25th Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association*, Academia Sinica, Taiwan, May 10–12.
- 2016 Prosodic conditioning in derived environment effects. *13th Old World Conference in Phonology*, Budapest, Hungary, January 13–16.

### Teaching

#### San José State University

##### Primary Instructor

- Introduction to Linguistics (undergraduate)  
Spring 2023
- Introduction to Syntax (undergraduate)  
Fall 2022, Spring 2023
- Introduction to Semantics and Discourse (undergraduate)  
Fall 2022
- Syntactic Theory (graduate)  
Spring 2023

- Semantic Structures (graduate)  
Fall 2022

## Other Teaching

### Primary Instructor

- Introduction to Linguistics (undergraduate)  
New York University (Summer 2018)

### Guest Lecturer

- Advanced Syntax (undergraduate)  
New York University (Spring 2019)
- Syntax Seminar (graduate)  
Yale University (Fall 2019), New York University (Spring 2020),  
McGill University (Winter 2021), University of Leipzig (Summer 2021),  
University of Massachusetts Amherst (Spring 2022)

### Teaching Assistant

- Introduction to Linguistics (undergraduate)  
University of Toronto (Winter 2015), New York University (Spring 2017)
- Morphology (undergraduate)  
University of Toronto (Fall 2014), New York University (Spring 2019)
- Phonology (undergraduate)  
New York University (Spring 2018)

## Service

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### Linguistic Society of America

- 2022–      Committee on Linguistic Institutes and Fellowships
- 2018      Strategic Planning Committee (LSA Long-range Strategic Plan 2019–2023)
- 2017–2019   Executive Committee (ex officio as Bloch Fellow)
- 2017–2019   Chair, Committee on Student Issues and Concerns

### Department of Linguistics and Language Development, San José State University

- 2022–      Curriculum Committee
- 2022–      MA Curriculum Subcommittee

### Department of Linguistics, New York University

- 2016–2019   Co-organizer, Morph Beer (morphology reading group)
- 2016–2017   President, Linguistics Association of NYU

## Conference Organization

- 2022 Austronesian and Papuan Languages and Linguistics Conference 14  
Leibniz-ZAS and HU Berlin, June 9–11 (hybrid)
- 2019 MarantzFest  
New York University, January 6
- 2018 Symposium on The Syntax of Clausal Arguments  
Linguistic Society of America 2018 Annual Meeting  
Salt Lake City, Utah, January 4–7
- 2017 Annual Meeting on Phonology 2017  
New York University, September 15–17

## Reviewing

### Journal Articles

- *Linguistic Inquiry, Natural Language & Linguistic Theory, Journal of Linguistics, Syntax, Glossa: A journal of general linguistics, The Linguistic Review, Studia Linguistica, Journal of East Asian Linguistics, Journal of Comparative Germanic Linguistics, Frontiers in Psychology: Language Sciences, Languages, NUSA: Linguistic studies of languages in and around Indonesia*

### Conference Abstracts

- Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting, West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL), Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association (AFLA), Brussels Conference in Generative Linguistics (BCGL), Austronesian and Papuan Languages and Linguistics Conference (APLL), Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic (Tu+), Stony Brook-Yale-NYU-CUNY Conference (SYNC)

## Languages and Skills

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### Languages

- Spoken: English (native), Mandarin (heritage, intermediate), French (intermediate)
- Current research: Tagalog, French, Italian, Korean, Japanese
- Previous research: Turkish, Khoekhoe (Central Khoisan; Namibia), Kipsigis (Nilotic; Kenya)

### Technical Skills

- Data collection: Labvanced, Penn Controller/Ibex, Qualtrics, Amazon Mechanical Turk
- Analysis: Python, R, CLAN